

0.0.1 Moonlit Night

juṇhasuttam

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time, the Auspicious One was living at Rājagaha at the Bamboo Grove, the Squirrel's Feeding Place. At that time the venerable Sariputta and the venerable Mahamoggallana were dwelling at the Pidgeon's Grotto. At that time the venerable Sariputta was seated in the open air on a moonlit night with a freshly shaven head, having attained to a certain type of samadhi. At that time two yakkhas who were friends were travelling from northern region to the southern region on some business. Those yakkhas saw the venerable Sariputta seated in the open air on a moonlit night with a freshly shaven head. Having seen, one of the yakkhas said this to the second yakkha: "It occurs to me, O friend, to strike a blow on this samana's head." When thus was said, the [second] yakkha said this to that yakkha: "Enough friend. Do not assault this samana. Eminent, O friend, is this samana, of great power, of great majesty." Also for a second time, that yakkha said this to the second yakkha: "It occurs to me, O friend, to strike a blow on this samana's head." Also for a second time, the [second] yakkha said this to that yakkha: "Enough friend. Do not assault this samana. Eminent, O friend, is this samana, of great power, of great majesty." Also for a third time, that yakkha said this to the third yakkha: "It occurs to me, O friend, to strike a blow on this samana's head." Also for a third time, the [second]

yakkha said this to that yakkha: “Enough friend. Do not assault this samaṇa. Eminent, O friend, is this samana, of great power, of great majesty.”

evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā rāja-
gahe viharati. veḷuvane kalandakanivāpe. tena
kho pana samayena āyasmā ca sārīputto āyasmā
ca mahāmoggalālāno kapotakandarāyaṃ viharanti.
tena kho pana samayena āyasmā sārīputto juṇ-
hāya rattiyā navoropitehi kesehi abbhokāse ni-
sinno hoti, aññataraṃ samādhim samāpajjitvā. tena
kho pana samayena dve yakkhā sahāyakā utta-
rāya disāya dakkhiṇaṃdisaṃ gacchanti, kenaci-
deva karaṇīyena. addasaṃsu kho te yakkhā āyas-
mantam sārīputtam juṇhāya rattiyā navoropitehi
kesehi abbhokāse nisinnam. disvāna eko yakkho
dutiyaṃ yakkham etadavoca: "paṭibhāti maṃ samma,
imassa samaṇassa sise pahāraṃ dātum"ti. evaṃ
vutte so yakkho tam yakkham etadavoca: " alaṃ
samma, mā samaṇam āsādesi. ulāro so samma
samaṇo mahiddhiko mahānubhāvo"ti dutiyampi
kho so yakkho tam yakkham etadavoca: " paṭi-
bhāti maṃ samma, imassa samaṇassa sise pahā-
raṃ dātum"ti. dutiyampi kho so yakkho tam yak-
kham etadavoca: "alaṃ samma, mā samaṇam āsā-
desi. ulāro so samma, samaṇo mahiddhiko ma-
hānubhāvo"ti. tatiyampi kho so yakkho tam yak-
kham etadavoca: "paṭibhāti maṃ samma, imassa
samaṇassasise pahāraṃ dātum"ti. tatiyampi kho
so yakkho tam yakkham etadavoca: "alaṃ samma,

mā samaṇaṃ āsādesi. uḷāro so samma, samaṇo mahiddhiko mahānubhāvo"ti.

2. Then that yakkha, having not heeded the [second] yakkha, struck a blow on the venerable Elder Sariputta's head. It was such a great strike that it could have felled a seven or a seven and half cubits elephant, or split apart a great mountain peak. Then that yakkha [crying out], "I am burning, I am burning!" fell into the great hell, just there.

atha kho so yakkho taṃ yakkhaṃ anādiyitvā āyasmato sārīputtattherassa sīse pahāraṃ adāsi: tāva mahāpahāro ahosi, api tena pahārena sattaratanāṃ vā aḍḍhaṭṭharatanāṃ vā nāgaṃ osādeyya¹ mahantaṃ vā pabbatakūṭaṃ padāleyya. atha ca pana so yakkho 'ḍayhāmi, ḍayhāmī"ti tattheva mahānirayaṃ avatthāsi².

3. The venerable Mahamoggallana saw with his divine eye which is purified and surpasses the human, that yakkha striking a blow on the venerable Sariputta's head. Having seen, he approached the venerable Sariputta. Having approached, he said this to the venerable Sariputta "I hope you are bearing up, O friend. I hope you are keeping on. I hope you do not have much pain." "I am bearing up, O friend Moggallana. I am keeping on, O

¹osāreyya - katthaci

²apatāsi - machasaṃ

friend Moggallana. Yet, I do have a small amount of headache.”

addasā kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno dibbena cak-khunā visuddhena atikkantamānusakena tena yak-khena āyasmato sārīputtassa sīse pahāraṃ dīya-mānaṃ. disvāna yenāyasmā sārīputto tenupasaṅ-kami, upasaṅkamitvā āyasmantaṃ sārīputtaṃ eta-davoca: " kacci te āvuso khamanīyaṃ? kacci yā-panīyaṃ? kacci na kiñci dukkhaṃ?"ti. "khamanī-yaṃ me āvuso moggallāna, yāpanīyaṃ me āvuso moggallāna, api ca me sīse thokaṃ dukkhaṃ"ti.

4. “It is marvellous, O friend Sariputta. It is unprecedented, O friend Sariputta, the extent to which the venerable Sariputta is of great power, of great majesty. Here, O friend Sariputta, a certain yakkha struck such a great blow on your head that it could have felled a seven or a seven and half cubits elephant, or split apart a great mountain peak, yet the venerable Sariputta says thus: “I am bearing up, O friend Moggallana. I am keeping on, O friend Moggallana. Yet, I do have a small amount of headache.” ” “It is marvellous, O friend Moggallana. It is unprecedented, O friend Moggallana, the extent to which the venerable Moggallana is of great power, of great majesty, in as much as he can see a yakkha. For now we are not able to see even a mud goblin.” the Auspicious One heard with his divine ear element which is purified and surpasses the human, the friendly conversa-

tion between this pair of great Nagas.

acchariyaṃ āvuso sārīputta, abbhūtaṃ āvuso sārīputta, yāva mahiddhiko āyasmā sārīputto mahānubhāvo. idha te āvuso sārīputta, aññataro yakkho sīse pahāraṃ adāsi. tāva mahāpahāro ahosi, api tena pahārena sattaratanam vā adḍhaṭṭharatanam vā nāgaṃ osādeyya³ mahantaṃ vā pabbata-kūṭaṃ padāleyya. atha ca paṇāyasmā sārīputto evamāha: "khamanīyaṃ me āvuso moggallāna, yāpanīyaṃ me āvuso moggallāna, api ca me sīse thokaṃ dukkhaṃ"ti, acchariyaṃ āvuso moggallāna, abbhutaṃ āvuso moggallāna, yāva mahiddhiko āyasmā mahāmoggallāno mahānubhāvo. yatra hi nāma yakkhampi passissati, mayaṃ panetarahi paṃsupisācakampi na passāmā"ti. assosi kho bhagavā dibbāya sotadhātuyā visuddhāya atikkanta-mānussikāya tesam ubhinnaṃ mahānāgānaṃ imaṃ evarūpaṃ kathāsallāpaṃ.

5. Then the Auspicious One, having understood the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance:

atha kho bhagavā etamatthaṃ veditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imaṃ udānaṃ udānesi:

“He whose mind is like,
the immovable, unshakeable;

³osāreyya - katthaci

faded away amidst the things that taint,
 unangered amidst things that provoke anger;
 he whose mind is thus enculturated,
 from where will suffering come?”

yassa ūpamaṃ cittaṃ,
 ṭhitaṃ nānūpakampati;
 virattaṃ rajaniyesu,
 kopaneyye na kuppati;
 yassevaṃ bhāvitaṃ cittaṃ,
 kuto taṃ dukkhamessatīti.

